LEADTO → JOB SATISFACTION ANALYSIS SYSTEM

Master Product Concept, Diagnostic Framework and System Design Document

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Version: 3.0
Product Category: Organizational Diagnostic and People Analytics System
Primary Users: HR Leaders, Organizational Development Professionals, Business Leaders and Management Teams

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1. Executive Summary

The LeadTO → Job Satisfaction Analysis System is an organizational diagnostic solution designed to help organizations understand employees' satisfaction with their jobs, identify the workplace conditions associated with that satisfaction, and determine appropriate improvement priorities.

Rather than treating job satisfaction as a single score or assuming that dissatisfaction is caused by a lack of motivation, the system examines four complementary domains:

1. **Overall Satisfaction** — the employee's overall evaluation of their job experience.
2. **Task Satisfaction** — the employee's experience of autonomy, purpose and appropriate challenge in performing their work.
3. **Relationships Satisfaction** — the employee's experience of belonging, positive workplace interactions and trust.
4. **Reward Satisfaction** — the employee's satisfaction with financial compensation in relation to peers, industry expectations and personal financial expectations.

The Overall Satisfaction domain is the principal outcome domain. Task, Relationships and Reward Satisfaction are diagnostic domains that help explain which aspects of the employee experience may be associated with higher or lower overall satisfaction.

The system follows the LeadTO ➡️ philosophy:

Diagnose first → Identify priorities → Select appropriate interventions → Measure change → Build organizational insight over time.

Its purpose is not simply to collect employee opinions. It is to help organizations translate employee feedback into practical, evidence-informed decisions about work design, management practices, relationships, compensation and other organizational conditions.

2. Background and Rationale

Job satisfaction influences how employees evaluate their work experience and may be associated with engagement, retention intentions, discretionary effort and organizational climate.

However, employees can be dissatisfied for different reasons. One employee may value the work but experience poor relationships with colleagues. Another may trust the team but feel that the role offers insufficient autonomy. A third may enjoy the work and relationships but be dissatisfied with compensation.

These differences matter because the appropriate response depends on the underlying issue.

A generic employee satisfaction score may reveal that a problem exists without identifying where management should investigate further. Similarly, an organization may invest in training when the underlying issue requires a change in workload, role design, leadership practice, compensation policy or working conditions.

The LeadTO ➡️ Job Satisfaction Analysis System addresses this challenge through a structured, multidimensional diagnostic approach.

The system is designed to help organizations distinguish between:

- The employee's overall evaluation of the job.
- The nature of the work itself.
- The quality of workplace relationships.
- Satisfaction with financial compensation.

This separation supports more focused analysis and helps reduce the risk of recommending interventions that do not address the underlying problem.

3. Purpose and Objectives

3.1 Purpose

To provide organizations with a structured and repeatable method for assessing job satisfaction, identifying areas requiring attention, and informing appropriate workplace improvement decisions.

3.2 Objectives

The system seeks to:

1. Measure employees' overall job satisfaction.
2. Assess the work-related experiences associated with satisfaction.
3. Identify strengths and areas requiring investigation across the four diagnostic domains.
4. Examine patterns across departments, functions, locations and other appropriate organizational groups.
5. Inform targeted interventions based on the diagnosed issue.
6. Establish a baseline for subsequent measurement.
7. Track changes in employee perceptions over time.
8. Help organizations build a more evidence-informed approach to employee experience and organizational development.

4. System Architecture

The system contains four domains and twelve subdomains.

Domain	Framework	Subdomains
Overall Satisfaction	GEM	General Job Satisfaction; Emotional Experience; Match with Overall Expectations
Task Satisfaction	TID	Thrilling; Important; Daunting
Relationships Satisfaction	BIT	Belonging; Positive Interactions; Trust
Reward Satisfaction	PIE	Peer Comparison; Industry Comparison; Expectations

Each framework contains three subdomains. Each subdomain has four survey questions.

Core survey architecture:

- 4 domains
- 12 subdomains
- 4 questions per subdomain
- 48 core survey questions
- 12 questions per domain

The framework acronyms organize the diagnostic components. They are not intended to imply that every component contributes equally to satisfaction or that the relationship between a component and overall satisfaction is necessarily causal.

5. Domain One: Overall Satisfaction — GEM Framework

5.1 Purpose

The GEM framework measures the employee's overall experience of their job through three distinct perspectives:

- **G — General Job Satisfaction:** the employee's considered evaluation of the job as a whole.
- **E — Emotional Experience:** the feelings the employee experiences in connection with work.
- **M — Match with Overall Expectations:** the degree to which the job experience aligns with the employee's broader expectations.

The three subdomains are related but are not interchangeable.

The distinction between the three subdomains

Subdomain	What it measures	What it does not primarily measure
General Job Satisfaction	The employee's overall judgment of whether the job is satisfactory and worthwhile for them	Momentary or recurring emotional feelings
Emotional Experience	The employee's feelings and affective reactions associated with work	A considered evaluation of whether the job is good for them

Subdomain	What it measures	What it does not primarily measure
Match with Overall Expectations	The degree to which the actual job experience meets the employee's broader expectations	Satisfaction alone, irrespective of expectations

For example, an employee may believe that a job is a good fit for their career but still experience frequent frustration. Another employee may feel positive about work on most days while believing that the job falls short of their long-term expectations.

These are different experiences and should remain distinguishable in the analysis.

5.2 G — General Job Satisfaction

Definition: The employee's considered evaluation of the job as a whole, including whether they regard it as a satisfactory working arrangement for themselves.

This subdomain focuses on the employee's overall judgment rather than the feelings they experience during the working day.

Survey questions

1. Overall, I am satisfied with my current job.
2. Taking everything into account, I consider my current job a good job for me.
3. I am generally pleased with the job I currently hold.
4. On balance, I regard my current job as a satisfactory working arrangement for me.

Measurement boundary

These questions ask employees to evaluate the job as a whole. They do not ask whether employees feel happy, calm, enthusiastic, frustrated or emotionally positive.

The questions deliberately avoid focusing on a specific satisfaction driver, such as compensation, relationships or autonomy, because those are assessed elsewhere in the system.

5.3 E — Emotional Experience

Definition: The feelings and affective reactions that employees experience in connection with their work.

This subdomain focuses on how work feels to the employee, rather than whether they consider the job a good arrangement overall.

Survey questions

1. My working experience generally leaves me feeling positive.
2. I usually feel content while engaging in my work.
3. My experience of work generally leaves me feeling fulfilled rather than emotionally drained.
4. When I anticipate a typical working day, I generally experience a positive emotional response.

Measurement boundary

These questions focus on feelings, emotional reactions and the affective quality of work.

They avoid asking whether the job is a good job, whether the employee is satisfied overall, or whether the job meets expectations. Those judgments belong to the other two GEM subdomains.

The questions are not intended to diagnose mental health conditions or determine whether an employee has a clinical problem. They measure self-reported emotional experience in the context of work.

5.4 M — Match with Overall Expectations

Definition: The extent to which the employee's actual job experience aligns with their broader expectations of the role and working arrangement.

Survey questions

1. My overall experience of this job is consistent with what I expected when I took it on.
2. This job has met my broader expectations of what a satisfying working experience should be.
3. The overall experience of my current job has lived up to my expectations over time.
4. Considering what I expected from this job, I am satisfied with what the experience has delivered.

Measurement boundary

This subdomain measures perceived alignment between expectations and experience.

A low score does not automatically mean that the job is poor. It may indicate that the employee's expectations were different from the actual experience, that circumstances changed, or that the organization made commitments that were not fulfilled.

Where appropriate, organizations should investigate the specific expectations involved rather than assume the reason for the score.

6. Domain Two: Task Satisfaction — TID Framework

6.1 Purpose

The TID framework examines how employees experience the work they perform.

It focuses on autonomy, purpose and appropriate challenge. These dimensions help distinguish between work that is restrictive, work that feels insignificant, and work that fails to provide a suitable balance between challenge and capability.

6.2 T — Thrilling: Autonomy and Control

Definition: The degree to which employees experience appropriate discretion and control over how they perform their work.

Survey questions

1. I have sufficient freedom to decide how I carry out my assigned responsibilities.
2. I can use my judgment when determining the best way to complete my work.
3. I have an appropriate level of control over the sequence or approach I use to perform my tasks.
4. Within the requirements of my role, I can make decisions without unnecessary interference.

6.3 I — Important: Purpose and Impact

Definition: The extent to which employees understand the significance of their work and perceive it as contributing to meaningful outcomes.

Survey questions

1. I understand how my work contributes to the objectives of my team or organization.
2. I can see the value that my work creates for the people who depend on it.
3. My responsibilities give me a sense that my contribution matters.
4. I understand why the work I do is important to the organization.

6.4 D — Daunting: Appropriate Challenge and Development

Definition: The extent to which work provides a suitable level of challenge, opportunities to apply capabilities and opportunities to develop competence.

"Daunting" is used in the TID mnemonic to represent challenge. It must not be interpreted as excessive pressure, unmanageable workload or persistent stress.

Survey questions

1. My work provides a suitable level of challenge for my current capabilities.
2. My responsibilities give me opportunities to develop and strengthen my skills.
3. I can take on challenging tasks without routinely feeling overwhelmed by their demands.
4. My work helps me build the competence I need to perform effectively.

6.5 Interpretation

Low TID scores may indicate that an organization should investigate work design, role clarity, decision-making authority, job significance, workload, capability development or opportunities for growth.

The scores should not automatically trigger training. For example, a lack of autonomy may require changes to approval processes rather than a training programme.

7. Domain Three: Relationships Satisfaction — BIT Framework

7.1 Purpose

The BIT framework assesses employees' experiences of workplace belonging, interpersonal interactions and trust.

It recognizes that satisfaction with work may be influenced by the social environment in which work takes place.

7.2 B — Belonging

Definition: The extent to which employees feel accepted, included and recognized as legitimate members of their workplace community.

Survey questions

1. I feel that I belong in my team or work group.
2. I feel accepted by the people with whom I work.
3. I can participate in team activities without feeling excluded.
4. I feel that my contribution is recognized as part of the team's collective effort.

7.3 I — Positive Interactions

Definition: The quality of day-to-day interpersonal interactions among employees and the people with whom they work.

Survey questions

1. My day-to-day interactions with colleagues are generally constructive.
2. People I work with communicate with me respectfully.
3. Workplace disagreements are generally handled in a professional manner.
4. My interactions with colleagues help me carry out my responsibilities effectively.

7.4 T — Trust

Definition: The degree to which employees perceive honesty, reliability and psychological safety in their workplace relationships.

Survey questions

1. I can generally rely on the people I work with to fulfil their commitments.
2. People in my team communicate honestly about matters that affect our work.
3. I can raise reasonable concerns without undue fear of negative consequences.
4. I have confidence that workplace concerns will be handled fairly.

7.5 Interpretation

Low BIT scores may warrant further investigation into team inclusion, communication, conflict management, supervisory practices, psychological safety, accountability or trust in management.

The system should avoid identifying individual employees as the source of a relationship problem from aggregated survey results alone.

8. Domain Four: Reward Satisfaction — PIE Framework

8.1 Purpose

The PIE framework assesses employees' satisfaction with financial compensation from three perspectives:

- Comparisons with peers.
- Comparisons with industry expectations.
- Alignment with personal financial compensation expectations.

Scope limitation: The initial version measures financial compensation satisfaction. It does not comprehensively measure benefits, recognition, career opportunities, flexibility or other non-financial rewards.

8.2 P — Peer Comparison

Definition: The employee's perceived satisfaction with their financial compensation in relation to people they consider comparable to themselves.

Survey questions

1. I am satisfied with my financial compensation relative to people performing comparable work.
2. My compensation seems reasonable in comparison with employees who have similar responsibilities.
3. I consider my financial compensation appropriate relative to my contribution compared with that of my peers.
4. I am generally satisfied with how my compensation compares with that of people in similar roles.

8.3 I — Industry Comparison

Definition: The employee's perceived satisfaction with financial compensation in relation to what they believe is typical for comparable work in their industry.

Survey questions

1. I am satisfied with my financial compensation relative to what I understand comparable roles in my industry to pay.
2. My compensation appears reasonable for the type of work I perform in my industry.

3. I believe my financial compensation is broadly consistent with industry expectations for comparable responsibilities.
4. I am satisfied with my compensation when I consider what similar roles may offer elsewhere in my industry.

8.4 E — Expectations

Definition: The employee's satisfaction with their financial compensation in relation to their personal financial compensation expectations.

Survey questions

1. My financial compensation meets my expectations for the role I perform.
2. I am satisfied with the level of compensation I receive for my responsibilities.
3. My compensation is consistent with the financial expectations I have for my current role.
4. Considering what I expected to earn in this position, I am satisfied with my current compensation.

8.5 Interpretation

Low PIE scores may indicate a need to investigate compensation structures, salary communication, role grading, market positioning or the alignment between compensation and responsibilities.

Employee perceptions are important diagnostic signals, but they do not establish that compensation is objectively fair, unfair, above market or below market. Where such conclusions are needed, the organization should use relevant compensation records, role comparisons and reliable market benchmarks.

Training should not be treated as a substitute for addressing substantiated compensation inequities or structural reward problems.

9. Survey Administration

9.1 Response Scale

The proposed response scale is a five-point agreement scale:

1. Strongly disagree
2. Disagree
3. Neither agree nor disagree

4. Agree
5. Strongly agree

An optional “Not applicable / Unable to assess” response may be included where a question genuinely does not apply or the respondent lacks sufficient information.

Such responses should not be treated as neutral scores.

9.2 Administration Principles

The survey should:

- Explain its purpose and how the results will be used.
- Encourage honest responses without fear of retaliation.
- Avoid collecting personally identifying information unless necessary and appropriately governed.
- Protect individual responses from unauthorized access.
- Report results at group level where sample sizes permit responsible interpretation.
- Establish minimum reporting thresholds before results are released.
- Avoid promising absolute anonymity if the administration method cannot guarantee it.
- Communicate the actions the organization intends to take after the assessment.

The survey should be short enough to encourage participation while preserving sufficient coverage of the four domains.

10. Scoring and Interpretation

10.1 Subdomain Scoring

Each subdomain contains four questions.

Where the survey data are suitable, the subdomain score may be calculated as the mean of the valid responses to its four questions.

For example:

General Job Satisfaction Score = Mean of the four General Job Satisfaction responses.

A score between 1 and 5 can be retained for interpretation. Missing responses and “Not applicable” selections should be handled according to a documented scoring rule.

The scoring method should be reviewed during pilot testing and validation. The system should not assume that every subdomain is psychometrically reliable merely because it contains four questions.

10.2 Domain Scoring

Each domain contains three subdomains and twelve questions.

Domain-level summaries may be calculated using an approved scoring method. The organization should document whether it uses the mean of all valid domain items or the mean of the three subdomain scores, particularly when missing responses occur.

The two methods may produce different results if response completeness varies.

10.3 Overall Satisfaction as the Outcome Domain

GEM provides the primary measure of overall job satisfaction.

Its three subdomains provide complementary information:

- General Job Satisfaction measures the employee's considered overall evaluation.
- Emotional Experience measures the employee's affective experience of work.
- Match with Overall Expectations measures perceived alignment between expectations and actual experience.

These scores should initially be reported separately. An overall GEM composite should only be introduced if validation supports its interpretation and the intended use.

10.4 Diagnostic Domains

TID, BIT and PIE should be examined in relation to GEM.

The analysis should explore questions such as:

- Do employees reporting lower overall satisfaction also report lower autonomy or purpose?
- Are relationship experiences associated with differences in overall satisfaction?
- Does financial compensation satisfaction vary alongside overall satisfaction?
- Do patterns differ across teams, roles, locations or other appropriate groups?

Such patterns indicate associations and areas for investigation. They do not, by themselves, establish that one factor caused another.

10.5 Score Bands

Universal score bands should not be treated as validated merely because the scale ranges from 1 to 5.

Any labels such as “low,” “moderate” or “high” should be developed through pilot evidence, psychometric evaluation and practical testing. During early implementation, it is preferable to show the scores, response distributions, comparisons and limitations clearly.

11. Diagnostic-to-Intervention Architecture

The system should connect diagnostic findings to possible responses without automatically prescribing a particular intervention.

Diagnostic finding	Areas to investigate	Possible response categories
Low General Job Satisfaction	Overall role experience and workplace conditions	Further diagnostic conversations; work or role redesign; management action
Low Emotional Experience	Sources of positive or negative work-related feelings	Workload review; supervisory support; interpersonal or operational improvements
Low Match with Overall Expectations	Differences between expectations and actual experience	Role clarification; communication; review of commitments and employee experience
Low Autonomy	Decision rights and unnecessary restrictions	Delegation; process redesign; manager development
Low Purpose and Impact	Visibility of contribution and organizational priorities	Role alignment; goal communication; job enrichment
Low Appropriate Challenge	Workload, capability fit and development opportunities	Work redesign; resourcing; capability development
Low Belonging	Inclusion and team integration	Team practices; leadership action; inclusion initiatives

Diagnostic finding	Areas to investigate	Possible response categories
Low Positive Interactions	Communication and conflict patterns	Team agreements; conflict resolution; manager development
Low Trust	Reliability, fairness and psychological safety	Accountability; leadership action; transparent processes
Low Peer Comparison Satisfaction	Internal compensation comparisons	Role and pay-equity review
Low Industry Comparison Satisfaction	Perceived external competitiveness	Relevant market benchmarking
Low Compensation Expectations Satisfaction	Financial expectations and perceived reward alignment	Compensation review; transparent communication; policy or structural action

These are possible investigative directions, not automatic conclusions. More than one issue may contribute to the same pattern, and the most appropriate response depends on the supporting evidence.

Training is one intervention category among several. The system should recommend training only where a capability or behaviour gap is supported by the diagnostic evidence.

12. Reporting Architecture

The system should support reports for appropriate audiences.

12.1 Executive Report

Designed for senior leadership and decision-makers.

It should present:

- Overall Satisfaction results.
- Key findings across Task, Relationships and Reward Satisfaction.
- Material patterns and organizational differences.
- Areas requiring further investigation.
- Recommended priorities and possible interventions.

- Limitations and areas where additional evidence is required.

12.2 HR and Organizational Development Report

Designed for HR, organizational development and relevant diagnostic teams.

It should provide:

- Domain and subdomain scores.
- Response distributions and sample sizes.
- Appropriate comparisons across organizational groups.
- Relationships between GEM and the diagnostic domains.
- Potential intervention pathways.
- Recommendations for follow-up assessment.

12.3 Management Report

Designed for managers who have a legitimate role in improving a team's working conditions.

It should focus on:

- Team-level strengths.
- Areas requiring attention.
- Practical management actions.
- Questions for constructive team discussion.
- Follow-up commitments and progress monitoring.

Managers should not receive identifiable individual responses merely because they supervise the respondents.

13. Privacy, Confidentiality and Ethical Use

The system must be designed to encourage honest participation and protect employees from misuse of their feedback.

Its implementation should include:

1. Clear communication about the assessment's purpose.
2. Appropriate data minimization.
3. Secure handling of survey responses.
4. Role-based access to results.
5. Minimum reporting thresholds to reduce re-identification risk.
6. Suppression or careful handling of small-group results.

7. Prohibition of retaliation for good-faith participation.
8. Appropriate retention and deletion rules.
9. Clear limits on the use of survey findings in individual employment decisions.

The system should be used to understand and improve the employee experience, not as a stand-alone instrument for ranking employees or determining individual performance.

14. LeadTO Ecosystem Integration

The Job Satisfaction Analysis System can complement other LeadTO ➡️ organizational diagnostic and development solutions.

Its role is to establish where satisfaction concerns may exist and what additional evidence may be required.

Depending on the findings, an organization may proceed to:

- A more focused diagnostic assessment.
- A work-design or operational review.
- Leadership or management development.
- Culture or change-management interventions.
- Capability development where a genuine skill or behaviour gap exists.
- Compensation or policy review where structural issues are indicated.
- Follow-up measurement to assess whether conditions and perceptions change.

This approach reinforces the LeadTO principle of diagnosing before recommending a solution.

15. Validation and Continuous Improvement

Before broad deployment, the system should undergo structured pilot testing.

The validation process should examine:

- Whether employees understand the questions consistently.
- Whether the three GEM subdomains are sufficiently distinguishable.
- Whether the questions within each subdomain measure a coherent construct.
- Whether respondents find any questions repetitive, confusing or difficult to answer.
- Whether the survey works appropriately across different roles and organizational settings.
- Whether the proposed scoring methods are reliable and interpretable.
- Whether results provide useful information beyond a single overall satisfaction score.

Particular attention should be paid to the distinction between **General Job Satisfaction** and **Emotional Experience**.

General Job Satisfaction concerns the employee's considered judgment of the job as a whole. Emotional Experience concerns the feelings associated with working. Although the two may be related, the survey should not simply measure the same overall sentiment using slightly different words.

The validation process should also examine whether Match with Overall Expectations provides distinct and useful information.

Where the data do not support the intended distinctions, the relevant items or framework should be revised before the system is treated as a validated diagnostic instrument.

16. Measuring Organizational Value

The system should help organizations assess whether diagnostic findings lead to meaningful workplace improvements.

Potential measures include:

- Changes in job satisfaction scores over time.
- Changes in the subdomains identified as priorities.
- Completion of agreed improvement actions.
- Employee perceptions of changes implemented.
- Relevant retention, absence, engagement or operational indicators where reliable data are available.

Changes in these indicators should be interpreted carefully. Improvement after an intervention does not by itself prove that the intervention caused the change. Organizations should consider other explanations, timing, sample composition and the strength of the evidence.

The system's value lies in enabling a more disciplined process of diagnosis, decision-making and follow-up—not merely generating scores.

17. Product Design Principles

The LeadTO ➡ Job Satisfaction Analysis System should adhere to the following principles:

1. **Diagnostic before prescriptive:** identify the issue before recommending a solution.
2. **Distinct constructs:** avoid unnecessary overlap among subdomains.
3. **Evidence-informed interpretation:** distinguish observed results from assumptions.

4. **Multiple intervention pathways:** recognize that not every issue requires training.
5. **Confidentiality by design:** protect employees and their responses.
6. **Practical reporting:** translate findings into decisions and actions.
7. **Continuous improvement:** validate the instrument and refine it as evidence accumulates.
8. **Responsible claims:** distinguish association from causation and perception from objective evidence.

18. Final Product Definition

The LeadTO ➡️ Job Satisfaction Analysis System is a structured organizational diagnostic solution that measures employees' overall job satisfaction and examines the work, relationship and financial compensation experiences associated with it.

Its four-domain architecture—Overall Satisfaction, Task Satisfaction, Relationships Satisfaction and Reward Satisfaction—provides a practical foundation for identifying employee experience patterns, prioritizing organizational improvements and monitoring change over time.

Through its GEM, TID, BIT and PIE frameworks, the system seeks to move organizations beyond generic satisfaction surveys toward a more structured and actionable understanding of the factors that shape employees' experience of work.

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Product development note: This document defines the proposed product architecture and initial survey instrument. The framework, items, scoring approach and interpretation rules should be piloted and validated before the system is marketed as a psychometrically validated assessment.